

Andy Stamos: fast foods instead of mechanical advice.

A life of corned beef instead of camshafts

By ALLEN BERRY

Service station operator Andy Stamos of Ascot Vale has worked 12 hours a day for a reputation for a first-class motor repair shop.

Yet because of a decision by Caltech, the oil company which owns and leases the service station, Mr Stamos may soon have to earn his living by putting tomato sauce on hot dogs.

The Melbourne Road service station is one of the first 72 in the eastern States to be turned into a Caltech Markham—a 24-hour store selling fast foods and fast cars.

Mr Stamos's laborious life is to be removed to make way for super-market-style shelves and his petrol pumps will become self-serve.

"I can't be a shopkeeper," he says. "My job is not hot dogs and corned beef. It is motor mechanics."

Mr Stamos was angry and disappointed yesterday after the Town Planning Appeals Tribunal turned the temporary plans for the development of the site.

He accused the town planner from the City of Essendon that argued that the proposed development would be the first in a two-kilometre stretch and a disservice to the local community. Essendon council had previously refused the permit to Caltech, but yesterday's tribunal decision overturned that refusal.

Granting the permit, the tribunal chairman, Mr W. E. Webb, said it was not up to the tribunal to take economic considerations

SW Libs battle as McDonald steps down

SYDNEY.—Five contenders have emerged for the leadership of the New South Wales Liberal Party after yesterday's decision by Sir Bruce McDonald to stand down.

Mr McDonald, who held the position for only four and a half months, stood down because of uncertainty over whether he would keep his seat.

State Liberal MPs will meet next Tuesday to choose their seventh leader in six years.

The five contenders to emerge yesterday were Mr Jim Cameron, 56, State deputy Liberal leader, a founding member of the Festival of Light, and campaigner against permissiveness; Mr John Dowd, 45, shadow Attorney-General and member for Lane Cove, who was defeated by Mr McDonald in the last leadership race; Nick Greiner, 56, the member for Kirribilli, who has been in Parliament a year, but has significant support; Kevin Kozlowski, 42, the member for Hawkesbury; and Mr Max Smith, 51, the member for Forster.

The Liberal Party will come under pressure Tuesday from the State National Country Party and its leader, Mr Leon Punch, who is keen to take leadership of the coalition Opposition from the Liberals.

If Mr McDonald loses his seat, the Liberals and the NCP will have 14 seats each in the Lower House. No date has been set for a meeting of MPs from both parties.

"Uncertainty"

Mr McDonald said yesterday he had stood down because of uncertainty as to whether he would be able to retain his seat in the North Shore after the 18 September elections.

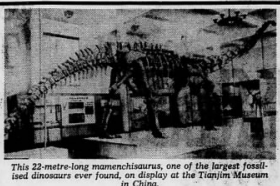
When the Liberals launched a legal challenge to the validity of the vote count in the North Shore—where Mr McDonald was elected—he seemed to lose his seat to independent candidate Mr Ted Mack.

The challenge, which centred on the validity of the count, was initiated by the Equity Division of the NSW Supreme Court, which ruled the case was beyond its jurisdiction.

The party has until 18 October to decide whether to appeal against the court's ruling, take up the case in the Court of Disputed Returns, or drop its action.

Mr McDonald has said he would like to remain in politics but continue to be active in politics as a deputy leader and whip.

Next Tuesday's meeting also will decide whether the party should challenge the result of Mr McDonald's seat, and the final election result, may require a by-election until 26 October, when the NSW Parliament reconvenes.



This 22-metre-long mamenchisaurus, one of the largest fossilised dinosaurs ever found, on display at the Triumf Museum in China.

China sends a sample of an ancient dinosaur

By PETER ROBERTS, Sydney reporter

The biggest, most spectacular collection of old bones ever seen in this country should be on display to Victorians by next February.

The bones—of the fossilised remains of a giant mamenchisaurus which lived in China 150 million years ago—are to be brought to Melbourne for a three-month public exhibition.

"Mamenchisaurus has been going to let you take their skeletons apart and more than about; they are pretty fragile things," Dr Rich said. "Why the Chinese are doing it is something they know. But whatever the reasons they have given us a great privilege."

The mamenchisaurus, which normally stands in China's Tianlin Museum, is made up of more than 200 bones and 22 metres long. It is one of the largest and best-preserved fossil dinosaurs ever found.

"It is certainly the largest one that is travelling overseas," Dr Rich said. "It is the only dinosaur of its size that people are willing to take down from one museum and move to another one."

The mamenchisaurus, which is a nine-metre long specimen in the Haining Act 1958 (this act

Smorgons plan new site for steel mill

By GEOFF STONG

Pressure from local residents has prompted Australia's largest family company, SCL Meat and Paper Pty Ltd, to drop plans for a steel mill near residential land in Tottenham.

Instead, the company is preparing to build the mill on a 24 hectare site near the Tottenham mill. This was to be done as part of the Government's New Directions policy aimed at promoting industrial growth.

In June, the Planning Minister, Mr Lieberman, invited a representative section of the Town and Country Planning Act to open planning permission for the Tottenham mill. This was to be done as part of the Government's New Directions policy aimed at promoting industrial growth.

The proposal, accepted last night, is to build the mill in Doberham Road, north of Geelong road. The mill will recycle scrap steel and produce 200,000 tonnes of steel products a year. It is expected to employ about 200 people. Smorgons have leased the site, which was built on a 7.2 hectare site owned by SCL near its existing steel works and paper recycling plant.

SCL, formerly known as Smorgons Consolidated Industries, has been the subject of frequent complaints about pollution from its existing factories. A senior executive with Smorgons, Mr Charles Ferguson, who attended the council meeting last night, said the company intended to go ahead immediately.

He said the problems with residents' objections to the mill were the reasons for the change. "Other and more serious" than the building and the proximity to Stony Creek, he said.

The company has already bought most of the equipment needed for the mill, which will be the first Australian competitor for BHP steel. The Port Phillip mill of Australia Iron and Steel is the last of the mill.

The Smorgons family have already taken on an existing Australian, monopoly, APF, and have secured part of its paper market.

But the decision has created concern about the impact on the environment. The new mill would be sited on a 24 hectare site, which would be a significant increase in the area of the mill. The mill would be a significant increase in the area of the mill.

Housing commission cannot evict under act: SM

By PAUL CHADWICK

The Victorian Government is likely to seek a Supreme Court review of the Housing Commission's power to evict tenants after a magistrate yesterday cast doubt on the legality of eviction procedures that have been used for more than 40 years.

Mr Brian McGrath, SM, ruled in the Victorian Magistrate's Court that the provisions of the Landlord and Tenant Act 1958 were not available to the commission as a method of regaining possession of premises it owned. The commission has been using the act in representation and eviction proceedings since 1958.

The Housing Commission had applied for an order for possession of premises occupied by four Aboriginal families in Shepparton. The Aboriginals were represented by staff of the Victorian Aboriginal Legal Service at the first court hearing on 23rd. After receiving oral and written submissions, Mr McGrath yesterday delivered his decision, in which he ruled that the provisions of the Landlord and Tenant Act 1958 were not available to the commission as a method of regaining possession of premises it owned. The commission has been using the act in representation and eviction proceedings since 1958.

Mr McGrath said he believed that apart from the Landlord and Tenant Act 1958, the commission had no other legal basis for its actions. He said the commission had no other legal basis for its actions.

He said he was satisfied that the commission was bound to act under the Landlord and Tenant Act which allowed the commission to evict tenants. He said the commission was bound to act under the Landlord and Tenant Act which allowed the commission to evict tenants.

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